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AFP

KARTARPUR SAHIB SHRINE SUBMERGED

The Kartarpur Sahib Corridor complex is partially submerged in floodwaters near the Pakistan-India border in Kartarpur yesterday. Pakistan authorities blew up an embankment next to a monsoon-engorged dam on Wednesday as flooding submerged one of the world's holiest Sikh sites. Three transboundary rivers in the east of the country have swollen to exceptionally high levels as a result of heavy rains across the border in India. **SEE ALSO P10, 11**

UAE's CBSE students won't need APAAR ID

ID must for students registering for the Grade 10 and 12 board exams in India

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

The Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) in India has issued a fresh circular announcing that schools situated outside India will not be required to implement the APAAR ID, a new mandatory requirement for students registering for the Grade 10 and 12 board exams. The latest circular directly impacts Indian students study-

ing in schools abroad, including thousands in the UAE.

The clarification comes just a week after *Gulf News* reported growing concerns among Indian expat parents in the UAE over schools demanding Aadhaar details to generate APAAR (Automated Permanent Academic Account Registry) IDs.

Big relief

"Schools situated abroad are exempted from APAAR because of various administrative reasons and laws in these countries," CBSE announced. The move is expected to bring relief to thousands of Non-Resident Indian (NRI) families in the Gulf countries and other regions.

"It is a big relief for students here. We were positive

that CBSE would consider the situation of affiliated schools abroad," said Dr Nasreen Banu, Gulf Asian English School in Sharjah, who was one of the principals who spoke about the concerns of students in the UAE.

In the same circular, CBSE also announced two separate schedules for submission of the List of Candidates (LoC) depending on the mode of fee payment. Schools have been asked to carefully check both schedules listed in Annexure A(i) and A(ii) to avoid last-minute issues. The circular makes it clear that the last date for both LoC submission and fee payment will be the same. CBSE has further cautioned that if fees are paid after the scheduled deadline, a late fee will automatically apply.

NATION

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Trump moves to limit students staying in US

FOREIGNERS CANNOT STAY FOR MORE THAN FOUR YEARS ON STUDENT VISAS

WASHINGTON

President Donald Trump's administration moved yesterday to impose stricter limits on how long foreign students and journalists can stay in the United States, the latest bid to tighten legal immigration in the country.

Under a proposed change, foreigners would not be allowed to stay for more than four years on student visas in the United States. Foreign journalists would be limited to stays of just 240 days, although they could apply to extend by additional 240-day periods — except for Chinese journalists who would get just 90 days.

The United States, until now, has generally issued visas for the duration of a student's educational programme or a journalist's assignment, although no non-immigrant visas are valid for more than 10 years. The proposed changes were published in the Federal Register, initiating a short period for public comment before they can go into effect.

'Forever' students

Trump's Department of Homeland Security alleged that an unspecified number of foreigners were indefinitely extending their studies so they could remain in the country as "forever" students.

"For too long, past administrations have allowed foreign students and other visa hold-

POLICY CHANGE

The US Department of State has announced a significant policy change for immigrant visa applicants, requiring most to undergo an interview in their country of residence or nationality.

An update yesterday on the US Department of State website read, "The Department of State is now requiring immigrant visa applicants to interview in the consular district designated for their place of residence, or in their country of nationality if requested, with limited exceptions."

— Dhanusha Gokulan, Chief Reporter

ers to remain in the US virtually indefinitely, posing safety risks, costing untold amount of taxpayer dollars and disadvantaging US citizens," the department said in a press statement Wednesday.

The United States welcomed more than 1.1 million international students in the 2023-24 academic year.

A group representing leaders of US colleges and universities denounced the latest move as a needless bureaucratic hurdle that intrudes on academic decision-making and could further deter potential students who would otherwise contribute to research and job creation. — AFP



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